

CLAUDE CODE

First 30 Minutes - Quick Start Guide

From zero to productive in 6 steps. Print this out, open your terminal, and let's go.

0:00	3:00	8:00	14:00	20:00	25:00
Install	First project	Commands	CLAUDE.md	First Hook	First Skill

1

Install Claude Code

~3 min

Req: macOS 13+ or Windows 10+ | Claude Pro (\$20/mo) or Max (\$100/mo) | No GPU needed

macOS / Linux

```
# Native installer (recommended)
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash

# Alternative: Homebrew
brew install --cask claude-code

# Verify
claude --version
```

Windows

```
# 1. Install Git for Windows first
#   git-scm.com (check 'Add to PATH')

# 2. PowerShell (Run as Admin)
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex

# 3. Fix PATH if 'not recognized'
$env:PATH += ";$env:USERPROFILE\.local\bin"

# 4. Verify
claude --version
```

2

Launch in your project

~5 min

```
# Navigate to your project folder
cd ~/my-project           # Mac/Linux
cd C:\Users\you\project   # Windows

# Start Claude Code
claude

# First launch opens browser for auth
# Sign in -> click Authorize
```

- Claude scans your project and is ready to work
- Type `/init` - Claude **auto-generates CLAUDE.md** with project config

3

Learn 8 commands + 7 shortcuts

~6 min

COMMANDS YOU MUST KNOW	
<code>/init</code>	Generate CLAUDE.md from codebase
<code>/compact</code>	Compress context (at ~80%)
<code>/clear</code>	Wipe history, fresh start
<code>/model sonnet</code>	Switch model
<code>/cost</code>	Token usage & spend
<code>/undo</code>	Roll back last change
<code>/plan</code>	Think before acting
<code>/help</code>	All available commands

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS	
<code>Shift+Tab</code>	Normal > Auto-accept > Plan
<code>Ctrl+C</code>	Cancel response
<code>Ctrl+F</code>	Kill background agents
<code>@file.ts</code>	Add file to context
<code>\+Enter</code>	New line in prompt
<code>Option+P</code>	Model picker (Alt+P Win)
<code>Option+T</code>	Ext. thinking (Alt+T Win)

REMEMBER

/clear between tasks (saves tokens) | /compact when full | @file for targeted context

CLAUDE CODE - First 30 Minutes (cont.)

4

Configure CLAUDE.md

~6 min

CLAUDE.md = project memory. Claude reads it EVERY session. /init creates a base - now refine it.

```
# CLAUDE.md - edit the file generated by /init

## Project Overview
E-commerce: Next.js 14 + TypeScript + Prisma

## Key Commands
- Build: npm run build
- Test:  npm test
- Lint:  npm run lint

## Code Conventions
- TypeScript strict, never use 'any'
- Components PascalCase, utils camelCase
- API routes validate with Zod
- No console.log in production

## Architecture
- /src/app      -> App router pages
- /src/components -> UI components
- /src/lib      -> Business logic
```

COMMON MISTAKE

Don't put EVERYTHING in CLAUDE.md! Keep under 200 lines.
Detailed workflows -> Skills. Universal rules -> CLAUDE.md.

5

Add your first Hook

~5 min

Hooks = automatic guardrails. CLAUDE.md says "don't do X" (~30% ignored). Hooks BLOCK 100%.

Method 1: Interactive (easiest)

```
# In a Claude Code session:
/hooks
# Select: Add hook > PreToolUse > Bash
# Paste command that blocks dangerous ops
```

Method 2: settings.json (full control)

```
// .claude/settings.json
{
  "hooks": {
    "hooks": {
      "PreToolUse": [{
        "matcher": "Bash",
        "hooks": [{
          "type": "command",
          "command": "check_safe.sh"
        }]
      }]
    }
  }
}
```

WHAT YOU GET

Exit 0 = allow | Exit 1 = warn | Exit 2 = BLOCK.
Claude cannot run rm -rf or git push --force. Ever.

CLAUDE CODE - First 30 Minutes (cont.)

6

Create your first Skill

~5 min

A Skill = reusable prompt invoked as /command. Write once, use forever.

```
# 1. Create the skill folder
mkdir -p .claude/skills/commit-msg

# 2. Create SKILL.md
cat > .claude/skills/commit-msg/SKILL.md << 'EOF'
---
name: commit-msg
description: Generate conventional commit
  message from staged changes.
---
# Commit Message Generator
1. Run git diff --staged --stat
2. Run git diff --staged for details
3. Generate: <type>(<scope>): <subject>
   Types: feat fix refactor docs test chore
4. Subject under 50 chars, body = WHY
EOF
```

Now use it:

```
# In a Claude Code session:
git add .
/commit-msg # Perfect commit message!
```

You now have a professional setup.

In 30 min: Claude Code + CLAUDE.md + Safety Hook + Custom Skill.
More than 90% of users have after a month. Time to ship real work!

PRO TIP: PLAN MODE

Press Shift+Tab before any big task. Claude explains its plan, you approve each step.
This is the #1 habit that separates beginners from power users. Start every session in Plan Mode.

CLAUDE CODE - What's Next

Your learning path

WEEK 1 - Fundamentals

- Master /compact and /clear
- Use @file to add targeted context
- Add 2-3 rules to CLAUDE.md
- Use Shift+Tab (Plan Mode) always

WEEK 3 - Advanced

- Create a subagent for code review
- Set up MCP server (e.g. GitHub)
- Try Agent Teams for parallel work

WEEK 2 - Automation

- Add hook for auto-lint on save
- Create 2-3 custom Skills
- Try /install-github-app for PR review
- Learn /fork for safe experiments

WEEK 4+ - Mastery

- Build and share a Plugin
- Autonomous workflows with Hooks
- Share your setup with your team

Desktop cheat strip - 8 essentials

claude

/init

Shift+Tab

/compact

/clear

@file

/cost

/undo

Print this and stick it next to your monitor. After a week you won't need it.

Resources & Links

Official Docs	code.claude.com/docs
Awesome Claude Code	github.com/hesreallyhim/awesome-claude-code
Skills Hub	skills.sh
Superpowers Plugin	github.com/obralab/superpowers